

Complete Geography of India – Competitive Exam Notes (UPSC / APPSC)

1. Physical Divisions of India

- Himalayan Mountains – Young fold mountains; divided into Himadri, Himachal, and Shiwalik.
- Northern Plains – Formed by Indus, Ganga, and Brahmaputra river systems; highly fertile.
- Peninsular Plateau – Oldest landmass; includes Deccan Plateau and Central Highlands.
- Indian Desert – Thar Desert in Rajasthan; low rainfall and sandy dunes.
- Coastal Plains – Western Coastal Plains (Konkan, Malabar) and Eastern Coastal Plains (Coromandel, Northern Circars).
- Islands – Andaman & Nicobar Islands (Bay of Bengal) and Lakshadweep (Arabian Sea).

2. Major Mountain Peaks

- Mount Everest – 8848.86 m (Nepal–China border, part of Himalayas).
- Kanchenjunga – 8586 m (India–Nepal border).
- Nanda Devi – 7816 m (Uttarakhand).
- Kamet – 7756 m.
- Anamudi – 2695 m (Highest peak in South India, Western Ghats).

3. Major Rivers of India

- Himalayan Rivers – Indus, Ganga, Brahmaputra, Yamuna, Sutlej, Beas, Ravi.
- Peninsular Rivers – Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri, Narmada, Tapti, Mahanadi.

4. Important Dams in India

- Bhakra Nangal Dam – Sutlej River – Himachal Pradesh/Punjab.
- Hirakud Dam – Mahanadi River – Odisha.
- Nagarjuna Sagar Dam – Krishna River – Telangana/Andhra Pradesh.
- Sardar Sarovar Dam – Narmada River – Gujarat.
- Tehri Dam – Bhagirathi River – Uttarakhand.

5. Plateaus

- Deccan Plateau – Largest plateau in India.
- Malwa Plateau – Located in Madhya Pradesh.
- Chota Nagpur Plateau – Rich in minerals like coal and iron.

6. Deserts

- Thar Desert – Also called Great Indian Desert; located in Rajasthan.

7. Seas and Oceans around India

- Indian Ocean – South of India.
- Arabian Sea – West of India.
- Bay of Bengal – East of India.

8. Climate and Monsoon

- Southwest Monsoon – June to September; main rainfall season.
- Northeast Monsoon – October to December; affects Tamil Nadu region.

9. Important National Parks

- Jim Corbett National Park – Uttarakhand.
- Kaziranga National Park – Assam (famous for one-horned rhinoceros).
- Gir National Park – Gujarat (Asiatic lions).
- Sundarbans National Park – West Bengal (mangrove forests, Royal Bengal Tiger).